MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT COWORK · **START HERE** · FREE, MIT LICENCE

Give Copilot a job it can do without you

23 ready-made bots for Microsoft 365 Copilot Cowork. Each one is a single file you upload once. After that you ask in plain English and it does the work, inside your own mailbox and files, under your own permissions.

What is Cowork?

The part of Microsoft 365 Copilot that **does the work**, not just the chatting. Chat answers a question in seconds. Cowork reads across your mail, files and meetings and comes back with the finished thing.

What a skill is

One file that teaches Cowork a job you keep repeating, so you stop explaining it every time. It sits in your own OneDrive. Nobody else sees it unless you share it.

Why these are safe to try

Every bot here reads and prepares, then stops. Sending, posting and deleting wait for a button you press. You can choose to pre-approve things later. No bot here decides that for you.

1. Pick a bot and **download its file**
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add → Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and ask it for the job

What is in the box

Core / Executive 1 bot	**Team Lead** 3 bots	**Finance & FinOps** 5 bots	**People & HR** 3 bots
IT & Ops 3 bots	**Projects** 3 bots	**Comms** 4 bots	**Sales & BD** 1 bot

THE RULE THEY FOLLOW

Silence is a result. A bot that invents a finding to look busy teaches you to stop reading it.

YOU NEED
Microsoft 365 Copilot with Cowork switched on by your admin. It is off by default.

NOT ON MOBILE
Uploaded skills only work on a laptop or desktop.

IT IS METERED
Cowork bills on usage. Your admin can cap what you spend.

ROOM FOR ALL OF THEM
You can hold 50 skills. These 23 use under half.

Download them all, free — github.com/kesslernity/awesome-copilot-cowork-bots

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Brand Answer Monitor

Tracks what a researcher finds when they look you up, week over week.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Tracks how the open web describes the brand on the questions that matter, and builds a weekly trend sheet of what a research tool finds when it looks the brand up.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add → Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"What does the web say about us?"*
- *"How are we showing up in AI answers?"*
- *"Run this week's brand check"*

What you get back

- A spreadsheet row per question, tracked week by week
- What moved since last week, and the four-week direction
- New sources quoting you for the first time

What it will never do without asking you

- Never claim to measure any named assistant's answers. The card and this file both say so.
- Never act on the findings: no content is published, no page is edited, nothing is sent.
- Never record a competitor's non-public information.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — A flat week is normal.

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MAKE IT YOURS
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Competition Monitor

Reports a material change and nothing else. The suppression is the product.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Watches a named list of competitors and reports only when something materially changed, staying silent when nothing did.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Anything new from our competitors?"*
- *"Check the competitor list"*
- *"Did anyone launch something?"*

What you get back

- A before-and-after table of what actually changed
- One line on why each change matters
- When nothing changed, one line saying so, and nothing else

What it will never do without asking you

- Never access anything behind a login, a paywall or a trial. Public pages only.
- Never report a competitor's non-public information even if a source offers it.
- Never characterise a competitor's intent or finances. Report the observed attribute.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

Silence is the success state and the most common one.

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Internal Newsletter Builder

Builds the round-up from what actually happened, and leaves a section out rather than filling it.

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What this one gives you

Builds a dated internal newsletter draft from the period's real material, every item sourced to the thing it describes, with nothing invented to fill a section.

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3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Draft this month's team newsletter"*
- *"What should go in the round-up?"*
- *"Build the internal update"*

What you get back

- A Word document in your usual section order
- Every item carrying the link it came from
- Empty sections left out rather than padded

What it will never do without asking you

- Never send or publish. Draft to the user.
- Never include anything on the config exclusion list: individual performance, anything about compensation, unannounced departures…
- Never announce something not already announced elsewhere. A newsletter is not the channel for breaking news to a team.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

A thin month produces a thin newsletter.

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Leadership Update Drafter

Writes the upward update in a fixed shape, with the uncomfortable parts kept in.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Drafts a leadership update in a fixed structure from the period's evidence, keeping facts and inferences visibly separate and stating what is not known.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Draft my update for leadership"*
- *"Write up my monthly report"*
- *"Prepare my steering committee update"*

What you get back

- Where we are, what changed, what is at risk, what I need from you
- A short list of what is still not known
- Facts and opinions kept visibly apart

What it will never do without asking you

- Never send. Draft to the user, always.
- Never soften or omit anything crossing the escalation bar.
- Never attribute a slip or a problem to a named individual.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

"Nothing changed this week" is a legitimate update.

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MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT COWORK · **CORE / EXECUTIVE** · FREE, MIT LICENCE

Calendar Defender

Finds the week's conflicts and the meetings that should not exist, and proposes, never acts.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Reviews the week ahead for double-bookings, meetings with no agenda or no decision to make, and lost focus time, then proposes specific changes without making any of them.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Check my week for conflicts"*
- *"Which meetings can I drop?"*
- *"Do I have any focus time left?"*

What you get back

- Your clashes, named meeting by meeting
- Meetings with no stated purpose and no decision to make
- Focus time against your target, and the exact changes to make

What it will never do without asking you

- Never accept, decline, move, shorten, cancel or create anything. Every output is a proposal for the user.
- Never touch anything on the config never-touch list.
- Never characterise a colleague's meeting as a waste of time. Report the absence of an agenda as a fact and let the user decide.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

A clean week needs one line.

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Budget Variance Explainer

Writes the story behind a number somebody else owns.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Drafts the narrative behind a budget variance from the context the user supplies and the discussion in mail and meetings, never producing or changing the figure itself.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Why are we over budget?"*
- *"Explain this variance"*
- *"What is behind the overspend?"*

What you get back

- Written commentary in your house structure
- A table of causes, with evidence and how much each explains
- The remainder that stays unexplained, stated plainly

What it will never do without asking you

- Never calculate, recalculate or forecast. Not even arithmetic on supplied figures.
- Never state a cause as certain when the evidence is circumstantial. Label it.
- Never write commentary that attributes a variance to a named individual.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — "Largely unexplained" is an honest and useful answer.

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Cloud Cost Digest

Explains what moved on the bill, with the question to ask each owner.

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What this one gives you

Turns cloud billing exports and provider alert emails into a short digest of what moved, what is anomalous and what to ask an owner about.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"What moved on the cloud bill?"*
- *"Explain this month's cloud spend"*
- *"Anything odd in the billing export?"*

What you get back

- The total for the period against the one before
- The three biggest movements, with the owner to ask
- Anomalies no explanation could be found for

What it will never do without asking you

- Never state a forecast as a commitment.
- Never recommend terminating, resizing or deleting a resource. Surface the movement and the question; the owner decides.
- The provider's own billing console is the source of truth. This reads an export.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — A flat month is a result.

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Expense Reconciliation

Finds the gap between what was claimed and what was evidenced, before someone else does.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Reconciles submitted expense claims against the receipts and statements sitting in the mailbox, lists what is missing or unmatched, and drafts the chaser to each claimant.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Check my claims against the receipts"*
- *"What receipts am I missing?"*
- *"Reconcile last month's expenses"*

What you get back

- Every claim matched to its receipt, or flagged
- Counts by status, and the total value unmatched
- A drafted chaser for each person to chase

What it will never do without asking you

- Draft, never send. Chasers are drafts.
- Never approve, reject or adjust a claim. Never state a reimbursable amount as final.
- The expense system and the finance ledger are the source of truth. This reads mail.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

A clean reconciliation is the best outcome.

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Invoice & Vendor Follow-up

Finds the invoice threads that stopped, with age and amount, and drafts the nudge.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Finds invoice and payment threads in the mailbox that have gone unanswered, ages them, and drafts the follow-up to each counterparty.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Which invoices have gone quiet?"*
- *"Who has not replied about payment?"*
- *"Draft the chasers for unpaid invoices"*

What you get back

- Every stalled thread, with its age and amount
- Who you are waiting on, and who is waiting on you
- A drafted nudge for each one, unsent

What it will never do without asking you

- Draft, never send. Especially never send a chase to a counterparty on the config exclusion list…
- Never state an amount as owed. The ledger is the source of truth.
- Never escalate a ladder step on your own. The user chooses the step.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

Nothing outstanding is a good week.

YOU NEED

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IT IS METERED

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MAKE IT YOURS

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Subscription Hunter

Surfaces every recurring charge in the mailbox before it renews itself, with a drafted reply ready.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Finds every recurring subscription, licence and service renewal hiding in the user's mailbox and files, and builds a dated renewal calendar with a drafted cancellation or renegotiation reply for each one.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"What are we subscribed to?"*
- *"What renews in the next 30 days?"*
- *"Find the subscriptions we forgot"*

What you get back

- An Excel sheet of every renewal, each row linked to its source
- What renews in the next 30 days, and what looks like waste
- A drafted cancellation or renegotiation, unsent

What it will never do without asking you

- Draft, never send. Cancellation and renegotiation replies are saved as drafts for the user to read, edit and send.
- Never cancel, downgrade or modify anything in a vendor portal, and never follow a cancellation link.
- Never state an amount as the authoritative figure. Finance systems and the contract are the source of truth; this reads what arrived in the mailbox.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — Finding nothing is a success.

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Change Advisory Board Prep

Builds the pack from what people actually wrote, and names every change that arrived without a.

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What a skill is

One file you upload once. It teaches Cowork a job you keep repeating, so you stop explaining it every time. It lives in your own OneDrive.

What this one gives you

Assembles the pack for the next change advisory board from the change requests, threads and documents already circulating, with the risk and rollback position for each change stated or marked missing.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Prepare the pack for the next CAB"*
- *"What changes are up for review?"*
- *"Which changes have no rollback plan?"*

What you get back

- The board pack: change, owner, window, risk, rollback
- Which changes arrived with fields missing
- Prior incidents on the same systems

What it will never do without asking you

- Never approve, reject or schedule a change. The board decides.
- Never write a rollback plan. Report its absence.
- Never state a risk rating of your own. Report the proposer's and say it is theirs.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

A board with nothing to review is fine.

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Defect Intake and Triage

Turns “it’s broken” into something an engineer can act on, or says exactly what is still missing.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Turns a reported problem in mail or Teams into a structured, ticket-ready intake with the evidence attached and the gaps named, then an Adaptive Card for approval before anything is filed.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *“Turn this bug report into a ticket”*
- *“Is there enough here to raise a defect?”*
- *“Triage what came in”*

What you get back

- A card turning the report into a ticket draft
- The exact fields still missing, written as questions
- Possible duplicates, linked

What it will never do without asking you

- Never file, create, assign or comment on a ticket without approval. Filing requires a work tracker plugin and the user’s explicit go.
- Never attempt reproduction. No terminal, no staging, no browser steps.
- Never declare a duplicate, a root cause or a severity the config does not support.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

A triage that concludes “not enough information, here are the three questions” is a success.

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Incident Digest

Rebuilds what happened and when, from the traffic, so the review starts from a timeline instead of.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Turns the mail and Teams traffic around an incident into a dated timeline with the open questions and who owns each.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Build the timeline for this incident"*
- *"What happened, and when?"*
- *"Prepare the incident review"*

What you get back

- A dated timeline of what happened
- What was observed, what was believed, what is known
- Open questions, each with an owner

What it will never do without asking you

- Never post to a channel, never reply to a thread, never update a status page.
- Never assign an action. List open questions with suggested owners for a human to assign.
- Never state a root cause. Surface what the traffic says and label it belief or finding.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — No blame, ever.

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Internal Expert Finder

Answers “who here has already solved this”, with the evidence, before anyone reinvents it.

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What this one gives you

Finds who inside the organisation has already done a given kind of work, with the evidence for each name, and drafts the introduction.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *“Who here has done this before?”*
- *“Find someone who knows this system”*
- *“Who should I ask about this?”*

What you get back

- A shortlist of people, with the evidence for each
- Who to ask first, and who to ask if they are away
- Where it looked, so you can see what it missed

What it will never do without asking you

- Never external. No sourcing, no candidates, no professional networks, no recruitment use.
- Never infer expertise from a job title, a team name or a reporting line.
- Never surface a document the user cannot already access. Enterprise Search respects permissions and this skill must not try to work around that.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

Finding nobody is a real and useful answer.

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Interview Loop Coordinator

Makes a panel cover the whole bar once, instead of four people asking the same question.

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What this one gives you

Prepares an interview loop: who covers which competency, what each interviewer needs beforehand, and a consolidated feedback pack afterwards scored against a written bar.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Set up the panel for this role"*
- *"Who covers what in the loop?"*
- *"Pull the interview feedback together"*

What you get back

- Who covers which competency, and what nobody covers
- What each interviewer needs beforehand
- Afterwards, the evidence, with disagreements shown

What it will never do without asking you

- Never recommend hire or no-hire, never rank candidates, never produce an overall score.
- Never create or send calendar invitations. Propose.
- Never include anything about a candidate not supplied for this process, and never search for a candidate externally.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

The pack never produces a hire recommendation.

YOU NEED
Microsoft 365 Copilot with Cowork switched on by your admin. It is off by default.

NOT ON MOBILE
Uploaded skills only work on a laptop or desktop.

IT IS METERED
Cowork bills on usage. Your admin can cap what you spend.

MAKE IT YOURS
Open *references/config.md* to set the names and thresholds.

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Onboarding Buddy

Turns “they start Monday” into a dated plan built from what the team actually has.

What is Cowork?

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Builds a dated first-fortnight plan for a new joiner from the team’s own documents, meetings and systems, naming who they meet and what they read on which day.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *“Plan the first two weeks for our joiner”*
- *“Who should they meet in week one?”*
- *“What should they read before Monday?”*

What you get back

- A day-by-day plan for the first fortnight
- Who they meet, and why that person
- What exists for them to read, and what is missing

What it will never do without asking you

- Never create calendar events or send invitations. Propose holds for approval.
- Never include anything about the joiner’s compensation, background or personal details.
- Never surface documents the joiner will not have permission to open once they start: note them as access needed instead.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — A short plan with real links beats a full one with placeholders.

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Document Transmittal Tracker

Answers “what did we send, and who still owes us a response”, from the mail itself.

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What this one gives you

Tracks documents issued to clients, contractors and authorities: what was sent, to whom, on what date, what response was due and what is now overdue for return.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add → Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *“What did we send the client?”*
- *“Who still owes us a response?”*
- *“What transmittals are overdue?”*

What you get back

- What was issued, to whom, and on what date
- What is overdue, grouped by party
- Revisions that quietly superseded an open item

What it will never do without asking you

- Never issue, reissue or transmit a document.
- Never chase a party directly. Drafts go to the user.
- Never mark anything as approved. Approval is a recorded act in the project’s own system.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — Nothing overdue is the goal, not a failure of the skill.

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Lessons Learned Harvester

Finds the lesson that has now been learned four times, which is the only kind worth acting on.

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What this one gives you

Pulls recurring problems out of close-out reports, retrospectives and project correspondence into a themed register showing which lesson keeps repeating across projects.

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3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"What keeps going wrong across projects?"*
- *"Pull the lessons from the close-outs"*
- *"What have we learned more than once?"*

What you get back

- Themes, and how many separate projects hit each one
- The lessons recurring across three projects or more
- Where the same recommendation keeps being made

What it will never do without asking you

- Never attribute a lesson to a named individual. Lessons attach to projects and processes.
- Never state a cause the source material does not state.
- Never rewrite a recommendation into something stronger than what was written.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

One project's lessons are not a register.

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MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT COWORK · **PROJECTS** · FREE, MIT LICENCE

RFI and Query Tracker

Shows which open questions are actually blocking work, rather than which are merely old.

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What this one gives you

Tracks open requests for information and technical queries: who asked, who owes the answer, how long it has been open and what it is holding up.

1. Download the file for this skill
2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Which RFIs are still open?"*
- *"What is blocking work right now?"*
- *"Who owes us an answer?"*

What you get back

- Every open question, with who owes the answer
- Which ones are actually blocking work
- Overdue items with no stated impact

What it will never do without asking you

- Never answer a query on anyone's behalf, and never draft a technical answer. This tracks; it does not opine on design, method or compliance.
- Never chase externally. Drafts go to the user.
- Never infer what a query blocks.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

An empty log is a good day on a project.

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Account Expert

One skill, one customer, context rebuilt from the tenant rather than from a CRM.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Owns the context for one named customer, rebuilding what is happening with them from mail, meetings and files, and producing a pre-meeting brief or a state-of-the-account summary on request.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Brief me before the customer meeting"*
- *"What is happening with this account?"*
- *"Catch me up on them"*

What you get back

- What changed on the account since last time
- Open commitments, both yours and theirs
- Who went quiet, and the questions still open

What it will never do without asking you

- Never contact the customer. Drafts only, and only when asked.
- Never produce a health score, a risk rating or a close probability.
- Never share internal commentary about the account externally, and never include internal pricing discussion in anything drafted to the customer.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — A quiet account is a finding.

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One-to-One Prep

Walks into the 1:1 knowing what you owe them, which is the half most prep skips.

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What this one gives you

Prepares a brief for a one-to-one with a named person: their open items, what they raised recently, what you owe them, and what has gone unanswered between you.

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2. In Cowork, open **Customize**
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add → Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Prep my 1:1 with Sam"*
- *"What do I owe them?"*
- *"What did they raise last time?"*

What you get back

- What they raised, quoted and linked
- What you owe them, and what is still unanswered
- Items carried over from last time, marked and counted

What it will never do without asking you

- Never assess, rate, or characterise the person. No performance language, no sentiment read, no "seems disengaged".
- Never read 1:1 notes about this person written by someone else.
- Never draft feedback, and never prepare anything for a performance process.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

An empty brief is a good sign.

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MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT COWORK · **TEAM LEAD** · FREE, MIT LICENCE

Project Decomposer

Turns a project into tasks somebody can actually finish, each with a stated way to tell it is done.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

Breaks a project, initiative or goal into owned tasks, each carrying its own verification criteria and a named owner, and returns one Adaptive Card per task.

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3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Break this project into tasks"*
- *"Who owns what on this?"*
- *"Turn this goal into a plan"*

What you get back

- A card per task, each with a named owner
- How you will know each task is actually finished
- The whole set saved to a file, so it survives the chat

What it will never do without asking you

- Plans only. Never create tasks in Planner or To Do, never send anything, never book time.
- Never assign a named person who has not already been associated with this work in the evidence.
- Never state a date as agreed unless the evidence shows it was agreed.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — Returning fewer tasks is usually better.

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Team Lead Mode

Runs the pack in order and assembles one review, rather than making you run four things.

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What a skill is

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What this one gives you

The orchestrator for a team lead's week.

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3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. **Add** → **Upload skill**, pick the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say the words below

Then just say one of these

- *"Set me up for the week"*
- *"Run my team lead review"*
- *"Prepare everything for Monday"*

What you get back

- One document: the three things that need you this week
- A section per report and per workstream, plus your calendar
- A run report saying which parts worked and which failed

What it will never do without asking you

- Inherits every boundary of the skills it calls, and may not relax any of them.
- Never send, post, create or schedule anything. It assembles.
- Never fill a degraded section with its own analysis. Degraded means thinner, not invented.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS — A quiet week produces a short review.

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